

# Uranium

92  
U

This heavy metal was the first substance to be identified as radioactive, a discovery made by the French physicist Henri Becquerel in 1896. It is used in the making of nuclear bombs and as fuel for nuclear reactors, which generate electricity.

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**ATOMIC MASS** 238.029

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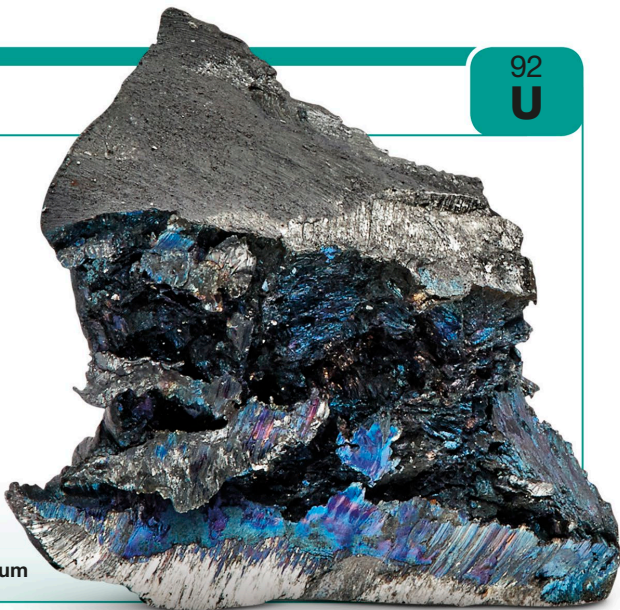
**STATE** Solid

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**DISCOVERY** 1789 (Martin Heinrich Klaproth), 1841 (Eugène Peligot)

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Chunk of pure uranium



# Neptunium

93  
Np

Sitting next to uranium on the periodic table is another radioactive element called neptunium.

This actinide was named after the planet Neptune. Neptunium was first discovered after being made inside a nuclear reactor. It is used mainly in scientific research.

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**ATOMIC MASS** (237)

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**STATE** Solid

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**DISCOVERY** 1940 (Edwin McMillan and Philip Abelson)

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Piece of uraninite, an ore that has tiny traces of neptunium

